

Markdown for Academia: Lesson 3 Final File

Elisabeth Maria Magin

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Abstract

This document exemplifies how to use Reference Managers, Citation Style Language and the LaTeX package glossaries with Markdown. It further demonstrates some useful Markdown hacks.

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1 Reference Managers & Citation Style Language

To have references autocomplete in Zettler, you need to follow these instructions:
<https://docs.zettlr.com/en/editor/citations/#enable-render-citations-setting>

1.1 Resources

See for example Groeneveld or Welber (2026).

1. CSL repositories
 - <https://www.zotero.org/styles>
 - <https://github.com/citation-style-language/styles>
2. editing CSL schemas
 - <https://editor.citationstyles.org/about/>
 - https://www.zotero.org/support/dev/citation_styles/style_editing_step-by-step

2 Useful Markdown Hacks

“Outcommenting text” means that it won’t appear in the output file, whether that is .docx, .html or .pdf.

2.1 Outcommenting

Outcommenting is incredibly useful if you’re still working on something or simply do not want a whole document exported.

3 LaTeX “glossaries” in Markdown

<https://ctan.org/pkg/glossaries>

When using Markdown (MD) simply to write text, it is generally enough to find the right Markdown application (MDA) to create well-structured, pretty documents. When using MD in academia, additional software can, however, be useful. Reference managers are generally a good idea when working with citations; additionally, monographs often also contain glossaries and indexes.

Using the LaTeX package “glossaries”, it becomes possible to create PDFs with a combined glossary and index. These Portable Document Format files can still be transformed into Word or HTML files, but it will require more work – *glossaries* is a very advanced LaTeX package and the generic LaTeX output is Portable Document Format (PDF). While the *glossaries* package still works fairly well in combination with Markdown, if you need a lot of specific layout in your documents, consider using LaTeX directly. Markdown can do a lot, but some things are just a bit beyond its capabilities!

ALWAYS remember to close the exported PDF before exporting again – LaTeX will throw up an error if you don’t!

4 Bibliography

Groeneveld, Wouter. “How to Write Academic Papers in Markdown. Brain Baking.” <https://brainbaking.com/post/2021/02/writing-academic-papers-in-markdown/>.

Welber, Audrey B. 2026. “Research Guides: Using Zotero at Princeton: Zotero with BibTeX/LaTeX.” Accessed March 3. <https://libguides.princeton.edu/c.php?g=148292&p=991756>.

Indexed Glossary

glossary explains important terms. 2

index lists occurrences of specific terms in a work. 2

reference manager software application. 2